

AABCF Fellowship Experience and Impact Survey Analysis

This report presents an analysis of survey responses from 15 AABCF fellowship participants. The analysis examines fellowship engagement, participant learning outcomes, the impact of the fellowship on research application, and alignment with organizational outcomes.

1. Fellowship Engagement

Respondents undertook research in the following climate smart livestock research themes: Methane emission mitigation and measurement (25%), resilient breed selection (12.5%), climate change and disasters and animal health (18.75%), alternative fodder system (12.5%). 30% of the fellows participated in research aligned to waste management in livestock production systems, forage biomass modelling using drone data and alternative poultry feed.

- 86.7% of fellows reported that the fellowship provided sufficient collaboration opportunities for further smart climate livestock research.
- 93.3% expressed interest in continued collaboration with ILRI.
- 86.7% reported that facilities and materials were conducive for learning.

Qualitative trends show that fellows highly valued networking, mentorship, field visits, hands-on laboratory experience, and exposure to world-class research facilities. Many fellows described the fellowship as motivating and professionally transformative.

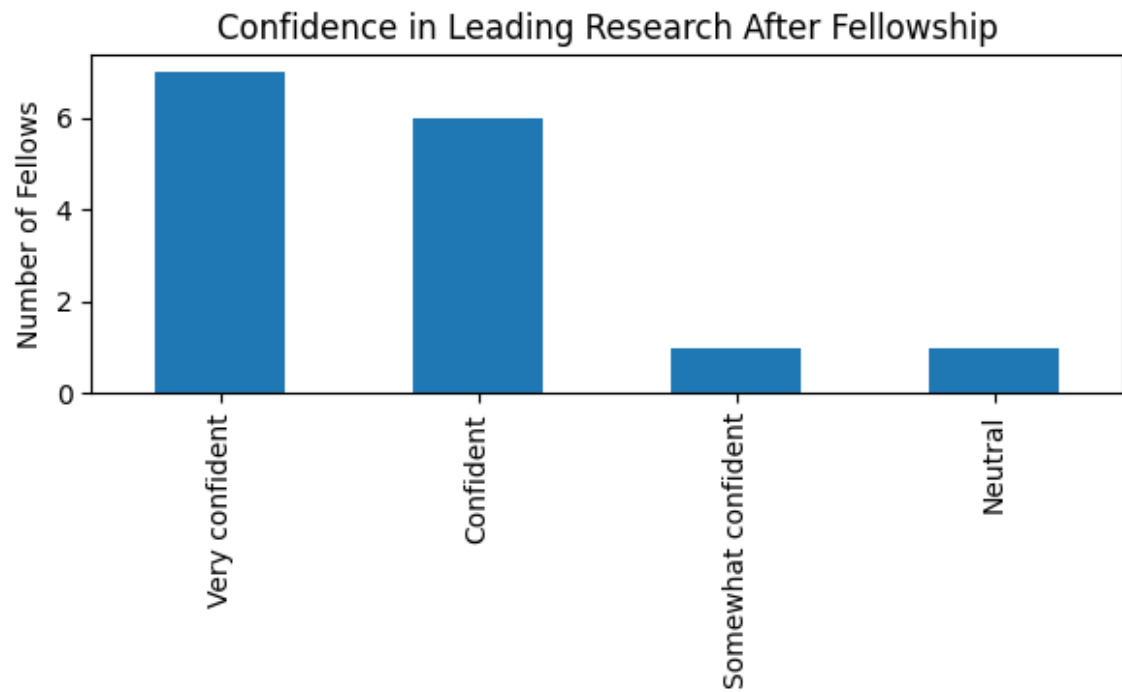
2. Participant Learning Outcomes

Participants reported gains in technical, analytical, and leadership competencies.

Commonly mentioned skills included:

- Scientific writing and proposal development
- Bioinformatics and molecular analysis
- Greenhouse gas emissions measurement
- Data analysis using R and Excel
- Presentation and communication skills
- Research design and laboratory procedures

The fellowship strengthened fellows' confidence, research leadership capacity, and commitment to climate-smart livestock research.

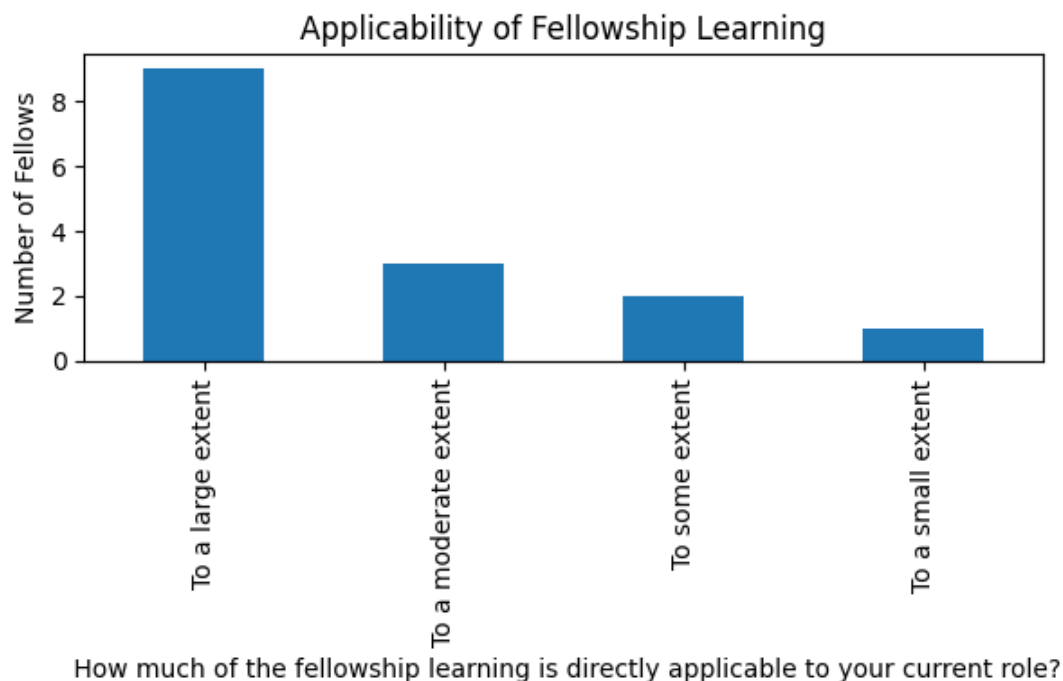


How confident do you feel in performing /leading research now compared to before the fellowship?

Trend analysis indicates that most fellows rated themselves as either 'Confident' or 'Very confident' in leading research after the fellowship.

3. Impact of the Fellowship and Application of Learning

86.7% of fellows indicated that the fellowship increased their desire to advance their research careers and explore new opportunities.



Most respondents stated that the fellowship learning was applicable 'to a large extent' to their current professional roles.

Fellows further indicated that they would implement the following at their current place of work:

- Train colleagues and students on new skills and knowledge acquired
- Apply new laboratory and analytical techniques
- Develop research proposals and write publications following their research activity during their fellowship
- Lead climate-smart livestock initiatives
- Expand and explore further institutional research collaborations

4. Learning Against Home Institutes Organizational Outcomes

- Overall, the respondents indicated that the fellowship contributed positively to their home institution and broader goals and outcomes by:
 - Enhancing institutional research capacity
 - Supporting proposal and publication development
 - Strengthening climate-smart livestock research systems
 - Building future collaborations between the home institutions and ILRI and partners
 - Increasing leadership capacity for research and training in national research and academic institutions.

Key outputs during the fellowship included: concept notes, draft manuscripts, proposals, posters, and ongoing publications.

5. Key Challenges and Improvement Areas

Recurring barriers and recommendations included:

- Fellowship duration was considered too short by many fellows
- Limited funding and infrastructure at home institutions may affect implementation
- Fellows requested stronger integration with ILRI teams and more advanced analytical training
- Additional support for field demonstrations and publication development was recommended

Conclusion

Overall, the fellowship demonstrated strong positive outcomes in participant engagement, knowledge acquisition, confidence building, and institutional impact. The program successfully strengthened technical and leadership capacities in climate-smart livestock resilience research. The survey findings also suggest strong potential for long-term collaboration and sustained application of fellowship learning across participating institutions.